

CAN

MIRACLES HAPPEN?

Imagine something really amazing happens to you—escaping unscathed from a plane crash, winning a television talent show, or discovering that an unknown uncle has left you a fortune. It would be a significantly life-changing event, and you might describe it as a miracle. Yet these sorts of things are actually the result of chance or coincidence rather than a miracle. The true definition of a miracle is a supernatural happening that cannot be explained in physical terms. Some religious people are certain that these miracles do happen, though there is as yet no scientific proof.

WHAT

ABOUT THE MIRACLES IN THE BIBLE?

For millions of people, the miracles that are described in the Bible, the sacred book of Jews and Christians, really did take place. Others look for alternative explanations. For example, the Bible says that God miraculously parted the waters of the Red Sea to allow the Israelites to flee Egypt. But what if their crossing had coincided with a seismic event, such as a tsunami, that caused the waters to recede? Such a powerful display of nature would have seemed like a miracle.

SO, ARE

PEOPLE CURED BY MIRACLES?

There are many reported cases of people being cured of a disease after praying for a miracle. They believe that God made the disease vanish. But maybe it was the power of their own mind—the belief that they would get better—that brought about their recovery. Or maybe they were getting better anyway. No one knows for sure.

